SHOWSHELF LAB · FOR THE AFTERNOON TEACHER

Teacher guide: Day 2

Students work through the steps in the Lab on their own. Each step has an explanation, a task, two hints and an answer button, so most of the time they can get unstuck alone. This guide gives you every task, a correct answer and the mistakes students usually make, so you can help quickly.

How to help: first ask them to read the "Not yet" message and the red Console line (if any), then open a hint. Only point at the answer after that. In the Lab, **Help › Teacher view** shows the answer and these notes on every step.

Day 2: Style it CSS

Yesterday's page works, but it looks plain. Today you give it colours, fonts, spacing and a card design with **CSS**, the language that says how things *look*.

The HTML is the same Friends page you built yesterday (our tidy copy of it). You only write CSS today, in a file called **style.css**. To see which classes and elements you can style, open the **show.html (whole page)** tab above the code box.

At the end you choose your own colours. They'll follow you through the rest of the course.

Step 1. Your first CSS rule ~15 min

Teaches: A CSS rule: `selector { property: value; }`.

TASK

Give the page a light background colour of your choice, using the `body` selector.

Some ideas: `#f6f5fb` (light violet), `#fdf6e3` (cream), `#eef6f3` (mint), `lavender`.

COMMON MISTAKES

- British spelling: `background-colour` doesn't work in CSS.
- Forgetting the `;` or the closing `}`.
- A space inside the hex code: `# f6f5fb`.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* style.css: how ShowShelf looks */

body {
  background-color: #f6f5fb;
}
```

Step 2. Text colour and font ~15 min

Teaches: `color`, `font-family` and `line-height` style text. Elements inherit them from `body`.

TASK

In your `body` rule, add:

- a dark text `color` (not pure black: try `#1c1b29`)
- a `font-family` without little "feet", for example `system-ui, Arial, sans-serif`
- a `line-height` of about `1.6`

COMMON MISTAKES

- A second `body { }` rule for each property (works, but keep them together).
- Missing commas between fonts: `system-ui Arial sans-serif`.
- Writing `font: Arial;` instead of `font-family`.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
body {
  background-color: #f6f5fb;
  color: #1c1b29;
  font-family: system-ui, Arial, sans-serif;
  line-height: 1.6;
}
```

Step 3. Colour the headings ~10 min

Teaches: Element selectors like `h1` style every element of that kind. Commas group selectors.

TASK

Give all `h1` and `h2` headings an accent colour of your choice, in one rule. Try a strong colour, like violet `#5b3fd6`.

COMMON MISTAKES

- A space instead of a comma: `h1 h2` means "an h2 inside an h1", which doesn't exist here.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  line-height: 1.6;
}

h1, h2 {
  color: #5b3fd6;
}
```

Step 4. Style by class ~15 min

Teaches: `.name` selects elements with `class="name"`. Sizes need units like `px`.

TASK

Make the facts line (`class="meta"`) smaller and grey: a grey `color` like `#676580` and a `font-size` of `14px`.

COMMON MISTAKES

- No dot: `meta { }` looks for a `<meta>` element.
- A number without a unit: `font-size: 14;` is ignored.
- A dot in the HTML: `class=".meta"`.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  color: #5b3fd6;
}

.meta {
  color: #676580;
  font-size: 14px;
}
```

Step 5. The box model: make a card ~20 min

Teaches: Box model: content, padding (inside), border, margin (outside).

TASK

The whole show is inside `<article class="show">`. Turn it into a white card:

- `background-color: #ffffff;`
- `padding` of `24px`
- a thin `border` , like `1px solid #e3e0f0`
- rounded corners with `border-radius: 12px;`

COMMON MISTAKES

- `border: 1px #e3e0f0;` without a style (`solid`): no border appears.
- Mixing up padding and margin.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  font-size: 14px;
}

.show {
  background-color: #ffffff;
  padding: 24px;
  border: 1px solid #e3e0f0;
  border-radius: 12px;
}
```

Step 6. Width and centring ~15 min

Teaches: `max-width` limits the width; `margin: 0 auto` centres a box.

TASK

In your `.show` rule, add a `max-width` of `640px` and a `margin` of `32px auto`.

COMMON MISTAKES

- `width: 640px` instead of `max-width`: the card is too wide for phones.
- `margin: auto 32px` (values swapped): no space above, and it isn't centred.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */

.show {
  max-width: 640px;
  margin: 32px auto;
  background-color: #ffffff;
  padding: 24px;
/* ... unchanged ... */
```

Step 7. Size the poster ~10 min

Teaches: Size images with `width`; the height follows.

TASK

Style the poster (`class="poster"`): a `width` of `200px` and slightly rounded corners, `border-radius: 8px`.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  border-radius: 12px;
}

.poster {
  width: 200px;
  border-radius: 8px;
}
```

Step 8. Header and footer ~20 min

Teaches: Style parts of the page by their class: header, logo, footer.

TASK

1. `.site-header`: a white `background-color`, `padding: 16px 24px;` and a `border-bottom` like `1px solid #e3e0f0`
2. `.logo`: `font-weight: bold;`, a bigger `font-size` (like `22px`) and `text-decoration: none;`
3. `.site-footer`: `text-align: center;` and a grey `color`

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  border-radius: 8px;
}

.site-header {
  background-color: #ffffff;
  padding: 16px 24px;
  border-bottom: 1px solid #e3e0f0;
}

.logo {
  font-weight: bold;
  font-size: 22px;
  text-decoration: none;
}

.site-footer {
  text-align: center;
  color: #676580;
}
```

Step 9. Links and hover ~15 min

Teaches: `a:hover` styles a link while the mouse is over it.

TASK

1. Give all links (`a`) your accent colour, the same as your headings.
2. Add an `a:hover` rule that changes the colour to a darker shade, like `#3d2a99`.

COMMON MISTAKES

- A space: `a :hover` means something different and doesn't work.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  color: #676580;
}

a {
  color: #5b3fd6;
}

a:hover {
  color: #3d2a99;
}
```

Step 10. A tidy table ~15 min

Teaches: `border-collapse: collapse` and cell padding make tables readable.

TASK

Style the seasons table: `border-collapse: collapse;` on `table`, and on `th, td` some `padding`, a `border-bottom` and `text-align: left;`.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  color: #3d2a99;
}

table {
  border-collapse: collapse;
}

th, td {
  padding: 6px 16px;
  border-bottom: 1px solid #e3e0f0;
  text-align: left;
}
```

Step 11. Your own colours with variables ~25 min

Teaches: CSS variables: define `--name: value;` in `:root`, use it with `var(--name)`.

TASK

1. At the top of your CSS, add a `:root` rule with two variables: `--color-accent` (your favourite strong colour) and `--color-bg` (a light background colour).
2. Use `var(--color-accent)` for the headings (`h1, h2`) and the links (`a`).
3. Use `var(--color-bg)` for the body's background.

Then change `--color-accent` to a different colour and watch the headings and links change together.

COMMON MISTAKES

- One dash instead of two: `-color-accent`.
- `var(color-accent)` without the dashes.
- `root { }` without the colon.

NOTE

The student's `:root` block is carried to Days 3 onwards automatically. If a student picks a dark `--color-bg`, later pages will be hard to read: suggest a light one.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* style.css: how ShowShelf looks */

:root {
  --color-accent: #5b3fd6;
  --color-bg: #f6f5fb;
}

body {
  background-color: var(--color-bg);
  color: #1c1b29;
  font-family: system-ui, Arial, sans-serif;
/* ... unchanged ... */

h1, h2 {
  color: var(--color-accent);
}

/* ... unchanged ... */

a {
  color: var(--color-accent);
}

/* ... unchanged ... */
```

Extra 1. Dark mode ~20 min

Teaches: `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark)` for a dark theme.

TASK

Add a `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark)` block that sets new, dark values for `--color-bg`, plus a light text colour. Tip: add a `--color-text` variable and use it in `body` for this.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  --color-accent: #5b3fd6;
  --color-bg: #f6f5fb;
  --color-text: #1c1b29;
}

@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) {
  :root {
    --color-bg: #12111a;
    --color-text: #f1f0f7;
    --color-accent: #a18bff;
  }
}

body {
  background-color: var(--color-bg);
  color: var(--color-text);
  font-family: system-ui, Arial, sans-serif;
  line-height: 1.6;
/* ... unchanged ... */
```

Extra 2. A poster that moves ~15 min

Teaches: `transform` and `transition` for small animations.

TASK

Make the poster grow a little and tilt when the mouse is over it, smoothly.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  width: 200px;
  border-radius: 8px;
  transition: transform 0.2s;
}

.poster:hover {
  transform: scale(1.05) rotate(-2deg);
}

.site-header {
  background-color: #ffffff;
/* ... unchanged ... */
```

Extra 3. Small, spaced headings ~10 min

Teaches: `text-transform` and `letter-spacing` style headings.

TASK

Make the `h2` headings uppercase, a bit smaller (`16px`) and spaced out (`letter-spacing: 1px`). Keep the `h1` as it is.

A CORRECT ANSWER

```
/* ... unchanged ... */
  text-align: left;
}

h2 {
  font-size: 16px;
  text-transform: uppercase;
  letter-spacing: 1px;
}
```